The small student apartment is filled with the sound of keys clicking. A young woman sits in an arm chair. Typing away at her laptop with a stern face. The light seems to flood in as Mike spreads the blinds to the sliding door out to the patio. Mike looks out, turning his head left to right. Mike frowns, “Huh”.

Ashley stops her typing, looks up at her partner then back at the screen. She sighs, “alright I’ll bite. What is it?”. Mike takes a second to turn and shrugs. “Oh, just, no birds”. Ashley goes back to typing. She offers him a nice and distant, “cool”.

Mike unsatisfied with that answer looks back outside, he puts his forehead against the glass. “Um… why do you think?”

Ashley half listening now, “What?”. Mike turns hoping to meet her eyes, “Like…” He just sees her typing and looks back outside. “Where did they go?”

Ashley shrugs and shakes her head slowly, “Don’t know babe. Look it up?”.

Mike doesn’t respond keeping his eyes on look out, scanning the lines of buildings and the coast of the lake he can see out in the distance.

Ashley looks up from her screen for a second at him, seeing him on high guard for birds, she chuckles to herself “you look like a dog staring out that window”. Mike hears and turns to her. “But like, its hot outside! Isn’t that like what they like?” Mike pouts for reassurance.

Ashley offers him a shrug as she keeps working. “I guess not darling. I know I have been complaining”, she gives him a half smile.

Mike looks back outside hoping he didn’t miss one while distracted. As he turns a small gray sparrow lands on their railing, maybe 4 feet from his face.

Mike smiles and announces, “Oh! A bird! A small gray guy!”.

Ashley lets a smile slip, “That’s nice hon”.

Mike looks back sharing her smile and checks his pockets for his phone. “I got to get a photo!”, when he brings it up the sparrow is flapping away. “Oh no!” Mike races to get a good photo, zooming in as far as his camera allows before the sparrow dives into a tree. “Oh yeah, there he goes.” Mike frowns as he checks his photos, “yeah bro is just pixels”.

Ashley is once again half listening as she gives him a, “yeah? Was he cute?” Mike doesn’t seem to mind, with a big smile “yeah!”.

Ashley returns his smile smaller, “you sound like a dog”.

Mike pouts but remember his phone, “oh right, I can gonna look it up.” Mike types into his search bar as he mouths along, “Why is there no ducks or other water birds at the lake right now and where did they go?”. He waits.

Ashley flicks her eyes up again, “So?” Mike reads for a second. Ashley stops

typing and looks up, “Babe? Where are your birds?”.

Mike smiles, “sooo… it says that the birds are in the north but that they should be back down here like next month.”

Ashley nods, “that’s good. Right?”. She goes back to typing happy with the verdict.

Mike turns back to the sliding door and pulls back the blinds slowly with a smile frown. He mumbles, “what a shame”. Ashley without looking up from the screen, “you miss them?”. Mike keeping his guard, “well… yeah. Remember when we had turkeys just running around?”

Ashley’s face lights up, “Oh my- yeah! And you almost got attacked because ye wared to get close-ups of them? They all stared at you!” Ashley slaps her knee as she laughs, “Oh my heavens! And you ran your little tush all the way home!”.

Mike turns crossing his arms then pointing a finger, “hey! They are scary in a squad!”

Ashley wipes a tear from her eye as she looks back at her work, “Oh my- thank GOD I was there to see that!”. She settles back into her work.

Mike watches the mail man’s truck do an illegal u-turn down on the street below. He gets bored. He turns to her brows tight, “what are you doing anyways?” Ashley speaks matter-a-factly now, “Inspection Contingency Response Form”. Mike thinks, he remember this deal from last week, “the Bentons’ deal?”.

Ashley sighs with a nod, “Yup. Timmy emailed me back and said he can’t do the gutter edges. Something about someone borrowed his ladder- I don’t know.” Mike tilts his head, “so?”

Ashley rolls her eyes, “So! Now I’m out of time and have to tell the buy we’re just offering credit instead”.

Mike rolls his eyes and pulls the blinds back again. Ashley looks up at the silence, “mike?”. Mike hums back.

Ashley, stops typing.

“Did you hear me mike?”, She raises an eyebrow.

Mike doesn’t turn back, “Oh yeah-yeah-yeah - totally-totally-totally”.

Ashley sighs and returns to typing. Silence falls between them again.

Mike still doesn’t see anything interesting outside, “ash?”

“Yeah-sweetie?” Ashley replies automatically.

Mike smirks, “hi”.

Ashley snaps the laptop shut, “Mike, go do the dishes.” Mikes back slightly startled, “What? Why me?” Ashley puts the laptop off her lap, “you made the mess Mike”.

Mike takes a step back, “you cooked dinner.” Ashley clamps her hands together, “exactly! I made dinner.”

Mike rolls his eyes. Ashley raises an eyebrow, “Did you just-“. Mike points, “You did it first!”.

Ashley puts her hand to her hip and points toward the kitchen, “Mike. Dishes!”. Mike throws his hands up and walks. “Fine! Gees, you sound like my mom”, Mike groans as he turns the light on.

Ashley keeps her face stern until he walks out of view, “Good”. A smirk grows as she takes the laptop back into her lap and goes back to typing.